

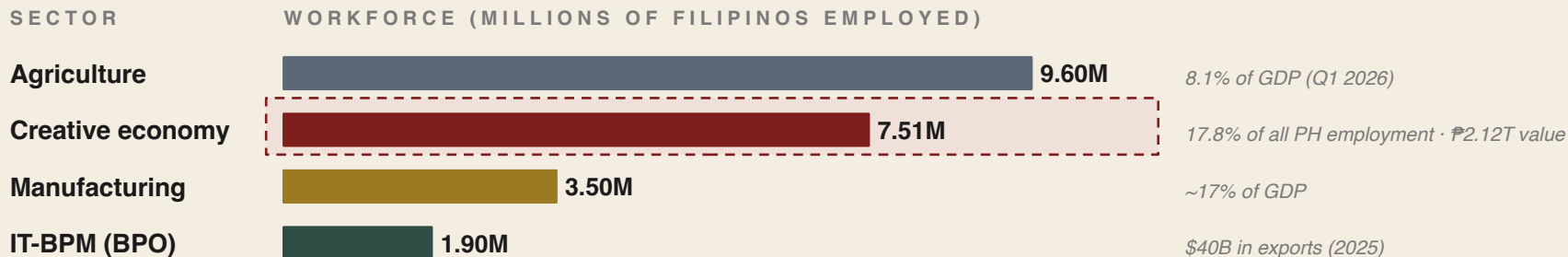
Visa.

A founder's case for adding outbound mobility to the Philippine Creative Industries framework.

BASIS	PSA Creative Economy data · RA 11904 / PCIDP MC 103 · a decade of personal advocacy
ASK	An IRR amendment, a Senate hearing, or a Creative Workers Mobility Act
SCALE	₱2.12T economy · 7.51M workers · 30% U.S. visa denial rate
AUDIENCE	Sen. Paolo Benigno “Bam” Aquino IV · for policy review and partnership

Creative is the second-largest sector by workforce in the country.

7.51 million Filipinos work in creative industries — already four times the BPO workforce, approaching agriculture in scale. ₱2.12T value, comparable to OFW remittances.

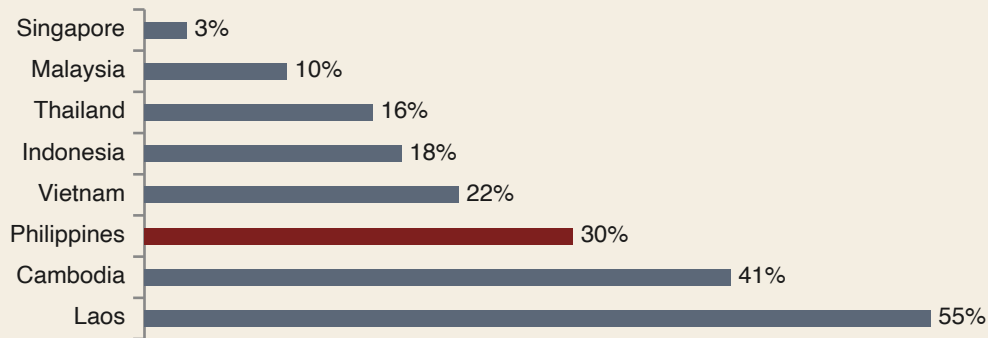


TAKEAWAY *Creative is bigger than manufacturing, four times BPO, approaching agriculture. Yet PCIDP MC 103 contains no outbound mobility provision.*

Source. PSA Creative Economy 2025 via BusinessWorld; IBPAP 2025; BSP 2025; PSA Agriculture Q1 2026.

Filipinos face the third-highest U.S. tourist-visa denial rate in Southeast Asia.

U.S. B-visa refusal rates by country of nationality, fiscal year 2024. Touring artists apply across multiple jurisdictions simultaneously — one delay drops a city.



THE ASYMMETRY

U.S., Korean, and Japanese artists enter the Philippines visa-free.

Filipino artists going the other way: 3-month process, \$185 fee, embassy interview, provincial travel — for a 30% chance of refusal.

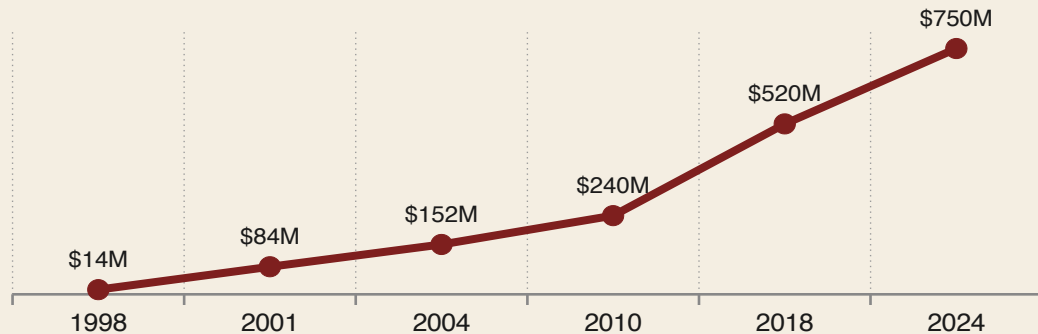
TAKEAWAY

U.S., Korean, and Japanese acts enter PH visa-free. Filipino artists face a 30% denial rate going the other way. Reciprocity isn't a foreign-policy problem — it's an asymmetry we let stand.

Source. U.S. Department of State FY24 visa refusal rates; SchengenVisaInfo Philippines 2023.

Korea's culture spend rose sixfold in three years — then Hallyu broke globally.

South Korean government spending on cultural industries, USD millions. The Philippines is already at Korea's current GDP share — without comparable state investment.



PHILIPPINES TODAY (2025)

7.6%

of GDP from creative industries — already at Korea's current share, without comparable state investment.

TAKEAWAY

We're already post-Hallyu in size. **Pre-Hallyu in policy.** The question is whether we keep doing the next chapter the hard way.

Source. Atlantic Council; Korea Herald (KOCCA, 2024 exports); PSA Creative Economy 2025.

Filipino artists put their visa frustration on a global chart.

SB19 — “VISA” · released 20 February 2026 · debuted #6 on the U.S. World Digital Song Sales chart · 3 months in flight globally.

*“Filipino **artists, athletes, and professionals** all face the same challenges with visa processes.”*

— SB19, on releasing “VISA”

50+

countries streaming daily — a campaign already in flight

3 months

since release — the Overton window has moved publicly

#6

U.S. World Digital Song Sales debut — real audience weight

Source. *Inquirer Entertainment; Lifestyle Inquirer; GMA; Wikipedia.*

A decade ago, before SB19, the same visa wall already stood.

A personal note before the policy ask.

This advocacy isn't new for me.

In 2014 I was a BPO call center agent. I was also part of a Filipino dance cover group called **Se-Eon** with Stell, winning regional competitions on our own savings.

That same year, Stell and I met BTS backstage — during their early “Danger” era, before they became the biggest band in the world.

They had state-backed scaffolding when they crossed borders. Filipino artists had nothing. **We were on our own.**

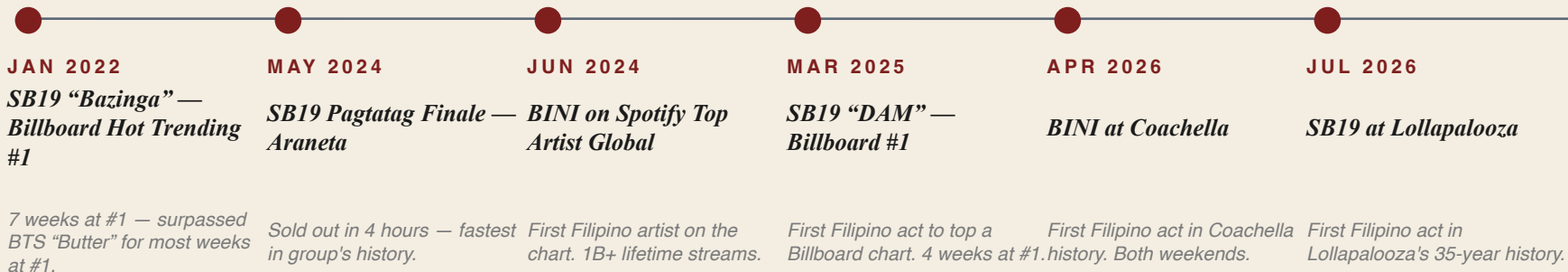
Even after proving ourselves in seven competitions, the visa wall was the same then as it is today.

TAKEAWAY *The song “VISA” is one expression of that thinking. **This meeting is another.***

Source. GMA News Online; Wikipedia (Josh Cullen, musician); Radar.ph.

Six Filipino firsts on global stages. None state-supported.

Each entry below is the first time any Filipino act achieved the listed milestone. None received dedicated state-export support.



TAKEAWAY

\$88M PH recorded-music market. \$1.8B Korea music exports (20×). *PCIDP MC 103 has no music-export budget line.*

Source. Rolling Stone; GMA; Billboard PH; Koreaboo; Newsbytes PH / PARI; Korea Herald.

The framework is already signed. The mobility chapter is missing.

Three current Marcos-administration instruments already cover creative-industry development. None of them addresses outbound mobility.

2022

RA 11904

Philippine Creative Industries Development Act

Established creative industries as a national priority. DTI lead agency. Created the Creative Industries Development Council.

DEC 2024

DFA Soft Power Roadmap

Released by Sec. Manalo

Cultural diplomacy as a pillar of Bagong Pilipinas. The Office of Cultural Diplomacy already issues endorsement letters.

OCT 2025

PCIDP MC No. 103

Signed by Exec. Sec. Bersamin

10-year creative-economy implementation plan. Already commits to “increase global market presence for Filipino content.”

TAKEAWAY

*The President signed the framework. The agencies have the mandate. **The 10-year clock is already running.***

Source. LawPhil (RA 11904); DFA via PNA; PCO; Supreme Court E-Library (MC 103).

Korea built five mobility instruments. PH has none.

Side-by-side: the export-support tools Korea built between 1998–2010, and their status in the Philippines today.

INSTRUMENT	KOREA	PHILIPPINES
Dedicated content-export agency	KOCCA (2009)	—
State-backed bilateral cultural treaties	20+ co-production agreements	—
DFA endorsement protocol for artists	Through MOFA cultural attachés	Ad hoc, request-by-request
Visa fast-track / talent-mobility track	E-6 reciprocity, MOFA support	—
Standalone music-export budget	KRW 1 trillion KOCCA budget (2024)	Not in PCIDP MC 103
TAKEAWAY	Four of five instruments don't exist on the PH side. The mobility pillar belongs in the PCIDP IRR update.	

Source. KOCCA; Korean Foundation for Cultural Exchange; PCIDP MC 103 (SC E-Library); RA 11904.

Three ways to add a mobility pillar to the PCIDP.

Graded by ambition and timeline. The senator picks what fits.

OPTION A

Convene a Senate hearing.

LOWEST-COST MOVE

- Committee on Culture & the Arts
- Calls DFA, DTI, NCCA to the table
- Public, builds record, generates momentum

30 – 60 days · minimal cost

OPTION B

Push the IRR amendment.

SURGICAL OPTION

- Direct request to DTI + NCCA
- Adds Mobility Pillar to PCIDP IRR
- We provide draft IRR language

6 – 12 months · no new appropriation

OPTION C

File the bill.

LEGACY MOVE — YOU AS PRINCIPAL AUTHOR

- Creative Workers Mobility Act
- Codifies the Mobility Pillar in statute
- Permanent inter-agency body

1 – 2 years · carries the next decade

*We'd want majority cover. **We trust your judgment on the co-author.***

You already solved this for the athletes. Filipino artists are asking for the same.

*“We have tremendous talent and potential to conquer the global gaming arena, which is why we worked with the eSports community to organize PeSPA **and to resolve visa issues when they compete abroad.**”*

— Sen. Bam Aquino, on PeSPA and Filipino esports

You organized PeSPA. You authored Senate Resolution 276. The athletes you championed already have the playbook **you built**.
The creative economy is already **four times the BPO workforce**.

*You've already done it for the athletes. **We came to you because nobody else has built this lane.***

Source. bamaquino.com (PeSPA / esports statements); Sunstar Manila (SR 276).